



WITH A CLASSY HIGH-ARM ACTION, MAYANK IS KNOWN TO ATTACK THE OFF-STUMP. MOST FAST BOWLERS SPRAY THE BALL TO GENERATE SPEED, BUT MAYANK'S STRENGTH IS HIS ACCURACY

caught short of time adjusting because Mayank is quick — consistently quick,” said Gursharan, the Delhi team’s batting coach. It was Mayank’s fortune that he got the support of Gursharan, who is well aware of the system in Delhi cricket.

The Delhi selectors often

overlook talented players, as seen in their past neglect of Virender Sehwag, Virat Kohli, and Rishabh Pant during their initial trials. In 2018, Mayank initially faced rejection but compelled the selectors to take notice of his impressive bowling speed, causing discomfort and fear among opposing batters in local tournaments.

Such pace at such local platforms was unnerving for the batters; quite a few were saved because of the helmets. “We won the Premier III Division DDCA title in 2023, thanks to his impactful bowling,” recalled Sharma.

Mayank can be menacing. He loves hitting the helmets, something he has come to love after growing up hearing stories of fast bowlers from his father. Prabhu’s fascination with bowlers hitting batters’ helmets paved the way for Mayank’s love of bowling fast.

South African great Dale Steyn

raved about Mayank in a social media post, even as former India wicketkeeper Vijay Dahiya took pride in his decision to rope the Delhi speedster into the Lucknow squad.

Dahiya was stunned to watch Mayank in action at the nets during the Vijay Hazare Trophy two years ago. He needed little time to convince the Lucknow franchise to invest in Mayank. Known as a promising talent scout, Dahiya knew immediately that he had found a “super talent.” Mayank earned a spot to play in the IPL and, in the process, may have taken a massive step towards achieving an India slot.

The season ahead holds promise for Mayank, already in the books of the national selectors, where Ajit Agarkar knows a thing or two about giving breaks to fast bowlers.

Mayank can always take that journey by getting drafted as a nets bowler when India travels for the ICC T20 World Cup in June and Australia for the Test series. India may be tempted to pick him for Australia, where the pitches suit his style.

At 6’1”, the 21-year-old Mayank is a hot property in Indian cricket. He can bowl a deceptive slower one and unleash a vicious bouncer, which makes him a dangerous bowler, especially on helpful pitches.

His well-wishers hope he maintains his fitness and serves the national team.

Mayank joins a long list of West Delhi cricketers who rose based on their resilience: Sehwag, Kohli, Ishant, Shikhar Dhawan, Amit Mishra, Gautam Gambhir, Aakash Chopra, Atul Wassan, Raman Lamba, K.P. Bhaskar, Sanjeev Sharma and Ashish Nehra.

“A fast bowler of his potential is rare,” emphasised Sharma. With Mayank’s mind-blowing speed, Indian cricket can look forward to some exciting times.

Good old days: Mayank Yadav (standing third from R-L) with his teammates at Sonnet Club.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

